Team 32

GameBoxd – A Social Video Game Rating & Discovery Platform

Project Vision Document

Version 1.0

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Revision History

Revision	Date	Author	Reviewed By	Summary of Changes
1.0	Sept 21, 2025	Vy Nguyen	Thinh Phan	Filled out majority of document
1.1	Sept 25, 2025	Thinh Phan		Filled out introduction, finalizing document

Document Approval List

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1 Introduction

GameBoxd – A Social Video Game Rating & Discovery Platform is a capstone project that provides gamers with a community-driven space to log, rate, and review video games. Unlike critic-focused platforms, GameBoxd emphasizes personal game tracking, backlog management, and social discovery. This document defines the project's purpose, scope, stakeholders, and high-level features to establish a clear vision for development and evaluation.

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to define the vision and scope of the GameBoxd project. It provides a shared understanding for stakeholders, outlining the business opportunity, system features, and user needs.

1.2 Scope

GameBoxd is a web and mobile application that enables gamers to log, review, and discover video games. It combines community-driven reviews with third-party game data from APIs (RAWG/IGDB) to create a personalized social hub for gamers.

1.2.1 In Scope

- User account creation, login, and profile management
- Personal "game log" (played, playing, want to play)
- CRUD operations for reviews and ratings
- API integration for accurate game data (title, release date, platforms, cover art)
- Social features: following friends, activity feeds, trending discovery
- Game search and filtering by title, platform, genre

1.2.2 Out of Scope

- Advanced monetization features (ads, premium subscriptions)
- Game purchasing or in-app commerce
- Console or game launcher integration
- Offline gameplay tracking

1.3 Definitions, Acronyms, and Abbreviations

- **CRUD** – Create, Read, Update, Delete
- **API** – Application Programming Interface
- **RAWG/IGDB** – Popular external video game databases providing metadata

This section explains all of the terms and abbreviations that are being used in this document, for those who are unfamiliar with them. Not everybody who reads this document will understand all of the terms, so this section is helpful.

Term	Explanation
CRUD	Acronym for Create, Read, Update, Delete – the basic operations for managing data in applications.
API	Application Programming Interface – allows GameBoxd to fetch game data from external databases.
RAWG API	A third-party video game database that provides metadata such as titles, platforms, genres, and release dates.
IGDB API	Internet Games Database API – another source of accurate game metadata (owned by Twitch).
UI/UX	User Interface / User Experience – design focus for usability and engagement.

1.4 References

<This subsection provides a complete list of all documents referenced elsewhere in the Project Vision. Identify each document by title, report number if applicable, date, and publishing organization. Specify the sources from which the references can be obtained. This information may be provided by reference to an appendix or to another document>

Reference File Name	Version	Description
RAWG API Docs	Latest	Documentation for the RAWG game database API.
IGDB API Docs	Latest	Documentation for the IGDB game database API.

Reference File Name	Version	Description
Letterboxd	N/A	Social film-logging platform used as inspiration.

This section also contains links to all other places that were referred to in this document. These may include:

- *Web sites*
- *URLs or network locations*
- *Research done for similar products*

Name	Link
RAWG API	https://rawg.io/apidocs
IGDB API	https://api-docs.igdb.com
Letterboxd (Film Inspiration)	https://letterboxd.com

2 Positioning

2.1 Business Opportunity

Gamers lack a centralized, socially engaging space to log and review their gaming activity. Current platforms focus heavily on critic reviews, leaving a gap for community-driven, social experiences.

2.2 Problem Statement

< Provide a statement summarizing the problem being solved by this project. The following format may be used>

The Problem of	fragmented and critic-driven game review systems
affects	gamers seeking personal game tracking and social discovery
the impact of which is	lack of engagement, difficulty in finding community-driven insights, and no personalized journal of gaming activity.
a successful solution would be	a platform where gamers log, share, and discover games socially.

Table 1 Problem Statement

2.3 Product Position Statement

< A product position statement communicates the intent of the application and the importance of the project to all concerned personnel >

For	gamers who want to track their gaming activity and share experiences,
Who	struggle with critic-dominated review platforms,
GameBoxd	is a social game logging and discovery platform
That	allows users to log games, rate/review them, and connect with friends.
Unlike	Metacritic or IMDb-style platforms,
Our product	focuses on community-driven reviews, personal logs, and social discovery.

Table 2 Product Position Statement

2.4 SWOT Analysis

<Reference: https://www.businessballs.com/strategy-innovation/swot-analysis/)

Strengths	**Weaknesses**
Social-first approach – similar to Letterboxd for films, but unique in gaming.	**New platform with limited user base** – building initial adoption will be difficult.
Integration with trusted APIs (RAWG/IGDB) – ensures accurate and up-to-date game data	**Dependence on third-party APIs** – risk if APIs change pricing or access terms.
User-friendly design – emphasis on simple logging, reviewing, and discovery.	**Limited resources** – as a student-led project, features may be minimal at launch.
Cross-platform availability – web and mobile for broader reach.	**Feature overlap** – some functions may already exist on platforms like Steam or Reddit.
Community-driven content – authentic user reviews, not critic-dominated.	**Scalability challenges** – growth in user base may strain hosting and database resources.
Opportunities	**Threats**
Rising demand for community-based platforms – gamers want social engagement, not just critic scores.	**Strong competitors** – Steam, Metacritic, IGN, and GameSpot already have established audiences
Niche market (Letterboxd-style for games) – little direct competition in this exact space.	**API restrictions** – RAWG or IGDB could limit free usage or change access models
Potential partnerships – indie game developers and gaming clubs could promote their games.	**Low adoption risk** – without network effects, the social aspect may fail to take off.
Expansion into features – achievements, leaderboards, or AI-based game recommendations.	**Privacy/security concerns** – user data (profiles, reviews, activity feeds) must be safeguarded.
Mobile-first gaming trends – strong demand for mobile apps that complement gaming lifestyles.	**Changing gaming trends** – new platforms or shifts in gamer behavior could make GameBoxd less relevant.

3 Stakeholder and User Descriptions

< This section provides a profile of the stakeholders and users involved in the project, and the key problems that they perceive to be addressed by the proposed solution. It does not describe their specific requests or requirements as these are captured in a separate stakeholder requests artifact. Instead, it provides the background and justification for why the requirements are needed>

3.1 Stakeholder Summary

< There are a number of stakeholders with an interest in the development and not all of them are end users. Describe and list the project stakeholders>

Stakeholder Name	Represents	Role
Team LevelUp	Project team	Developers, designers, testers
Gamers	End users	Provide reviews, use features, give feedback
API Providers (RAWG/IGDB)	External data providers	Supply accurate game information
Academic Instructor	Course stakeholder	Evaluates and guides project

Table 3 Stakeholder Summary

3.2 User Summary

< Present a summary list of all identified users of the system >

User Name	Description	Responsibilities	Stakeholder
Casual Gamer	Wants to log and track games	Create logs, follow friends, post reviews	Gamers
Core Gamer	Actively rates/discusses games	Write detailed reviews, discover trending titles	Gamers
Social Gamer	Focuses on friend activities	Follow activity feed, interact socially	Gamers

Table 4 User Summary

4 Stakeholder Requirements

< Categorize and list the requirements from the perspective of the business stakeholder and potential system users >

ID	Requirement	Stakeholder
R1	User authentication and profiles	Gamers
R2	Game log management (played, playing, want)	Gamers
R3	Review and rating CRUD system	Gamers
R4	Game data via API integration	API Providers
R5	Social activity feed and follow system	Gamers
R6	Search and filtering by genre/platform	Gamers

Table 5 Stakeholder Requirements

5 System Features

< List and briefly describe the system features. Features are the high-level capabilities of the system that are necessary to deliver benefits to the users. Avoid design. Keep feature descriptions at a general level. Focus on capabilities needed and why (not how) they should be implemented >

ID	Feature	Stakeholder Requirement ID
F1	User registration/login	R1
F2	Profile and personal game log	R2
F3	Rating and review system	R3
F4	External game data integration	R4
F5	Social features (follow, activity feed)	R5
F6	Search and filter games	R6

Table 6 System Features

6 Assumptions

- APIs (RAWG/IGDB) will remain accessible and reliable.
- Users will have internet access (web/mobile only).
- Early adoption will be among students and gaming communities.

7 Constraints

- Limited timeline due to course project deadlines.
- Dependency on third-party APIs for core game data.
- Limited hosting resources (free-tier or student credits).